GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

August 07th, 2026
Week 32
Volume 282, Issue 1247

Highlights:

- **Corridor opens.**
- **Tolls drafted.**
- **Freight surges.**
- **Inflation eases.**

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QUOTE of the WEEK

"There are some things you learn best in calm, and some in storm."
- Willa Cather

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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CORRIDOR OPENS, CONDITIONS APPLY

The week produced the war's strangest artifact yet: a peace process with a price list. Iran and Oman agreed a temporary shipping corridor through Hormuz, explicitly not a full reopening, while US officials said a nuclear agreement was within reach. Tehran's parliament took up a draft transit bill barring US and Israeli vessels, requiring hostile states to pay compensation before passage, imposing penalties of 20% of cargo value for violations, and making full reopening conditional on Washington lifting its naval blockade. Washington floated a 20% Hormuz transit fee in July and abandoned it. Tehran has now drafted its own, payable in the other direction. In this war, even the bad ideas change flags. By Friday, Iran said it had struck hostile targets in the strait, explosions were reported near Qeshm Island, the UK Navy reported blasts near a transiting tanker, and Houthi forces claimed fresh attacks on Saudi targets. The corridor exists. So does everything it was meant to avoid.

Oil deflated into the diplomacy and rebounded into the fine print. Brent fell for three sessions, helped by Saudi Aramco cutting Asian prices and US crude inventories rising from their lowest levels since 2018, before bouncing 3% on Thursday as the transit bill circulated. Brent closed near USD 82.84 and WTI at USD 77.67, down roughly 5% on the week and 15% from the July peak. Urals is up more than 50% on the month. The clearest beneficiary of a Gulf war remains, as ever, a country nowhere near it.

Freight has made up its mind emphatically. The Baltic Dry Index rose four sessions to 3,063, crossing 3,000 for the first time since early June, while Capesizes surged 6.6% in a day to 5,094 before both paused Thursday. Panamaxes reached 2,275, their best since June 15, while Supramax sat out the party at 1,608. Capesize earnings are up more than 20% in a week, and the recycling implication is familiar: the beach's stiffest competition is not another beach, but a freight market paying old ladies to keep working.

The data drought broke. Pakistan's July CPI eased to 9.2% from 11.1%, back in single digits, though monthly prices rose 1.2% and the improvement owes more to arithmetic than relief. The SBP held at 11.5%. Turkey's official July CPI eased to 31.75%, against an independent estimate of 50.49%. Both cooled. The gap did not. Bangladesh's print had not landed by publication, leaving June's 9.16% operative, with US and India CPI due Wednesday. Currencies moved first. USD/INR strengthened to near 95.20, its best since spring; the Taka held near 123.55; the Lira set fresh records near 47.71; and the Pakistani Rupee closed near 278.20, again inside a quarter-rupee range, now less a pattern than a covenant.

At the beaches, Chattogram's July 29 to August 1 window cleared the flood-era backlog and closed on schedule, with anchorage rebuilding toward the August 12 to 15 tides. Bangladesh retained the basin's best prices and firmest buyer confidence, while recovery from a month that killed at least 57 people is now measured in reopened yards rather than shelters. Alang buyers actively hunted tonnage after losing recent candidates to Chattogram and Gadani, the clearest sign in months that appetite is basin-wide, while the two-yard EU List proposal remains pending. Gadani's firm bidding finally secured deals, with deliveries to follow, as the absence of Iranian steel imports keeps local mills leaning on recyclers. Turkey remained Turkey.

The strait now has a corridor, the corridor has conditions, and the conditions have a price list. The beaches deal in simpler terms: a tide, a berth and a number. The market is moving, and for the first time since February, the paperwork is the only chokepoint left.

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 32 of 2026 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

WINDOW SHUT, LEAD INTACT

The interlude.

The July 29 to August 1 tide window closed on schedule on Saturday, clearing the backlog that built through the flooding, while anchorage has already begun rebuilding ahead of the next window from August 12 to 15. The monsoon has eased, yards are operating normally, and recovery from a month that killed at least 57 people is now measured in reopened plots and moving cranes rather than shelters. With the beach clear and a fresh queue forming, the fortnight between windows is doing what it always does: setting the price of patience.

Leads the board.

Bangladesh enters that fortnight with the basin's best prices and firmest buyer confidence. Enquiry remains healthy, with mid-sized units the preferred hunting ground. Enquiry remains healthy, with mid-sized units the preferred hunting ground. Local plate eased from BDT 64,700 to BDT 64,000 early in the week and held there through Friday, while vessel indications remained unchanged. The modest widening between steel and ship pricing has not disturbed buyer confidence, which after a month of weather, war and paperwork counts as its own kind of achievement.

The number pending.

The July inflation print had not landed by publication, leaving June's 9.16% operative a little longer. The bureau producing it is itself in the news, with a technical committee being formed to modernise CPI methodology and, in the government's words, restore trust in the figures. A statistics office announcing plans to make its statistics believable is its own kind of data point. USD/BDT held near 123.55, still pressing against the top of its band beneath the February 2025 record of 123.87, while the compliance caution that followed the sanctioned-tanker episode remains the standing filter on tanker candidates.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

Losing deals, gaining nerve

USD/INR extended its recovery to near 95.20 by Friday, the Rupee's strongest level since spring, as crude's retreat kept draining the pressure of July. The Reserve Bank has been able to stand aside for a second week, while Wednesday's CPI print, June's 4.38% surprise still the operative number, will be struck against a barrel roughly 15% cheaper than its July peak. The IMF, for good measure, nudged India's 2026 growth forecast up to 6.5% on resilient domestic demand.

Rupee runs.

Alang's sentiment lifted this week in the most convincing way possible: by losing. Buyers turned actively to the hunt after several recent candidates went to Chattogram and Gadani instead, and renewed appetite is visible even as local fundamentals remain soft and downstream steel demand subdued. Plate climbed from INR 38,300 to INR 39,200 through the week, while the strengthening Rupee lifted the USD equivalent to about USD 411.50 by Friday. This time the plate moved with the currency, giving Alang its firmest local-steel configuration in weeks. The next tide window runs August 9 to 18.

Appetite returns.

The two-yard EU List proposal remains pending, the dark-fleet lane remains open, and more than 115 valid Statements of Compliance remain the deepest bench in the basin. India's structural case did not change this week. Its mood did. A market that spends a fortnight watching rivals win deals and responds by bidding harder is a market that has decided the candidates are worth having, which, in a summer this thin on tonnage, is the only sentiment indicator that matters.

The door, still ajar.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

THE AUCTION FINDS BIDDERS

Deals, at last.

The fortnight of winning the price board and little else has ended. Gadani's firm bidding secured several of the basin's recent candidates, with deliveries to follow over the coming weeks, and basin reporting now lists Gadani alongside Chattogram as where Alang's lost deals went. The continued absence of imported Iranian steel keeps local mills leaning on recyclers for feedstock, plate held at PKR 200,000 per ton near USD 714, and buying appetite remains firm. The empty beach, for now, is a timing artifact rather than a verdict.

Nine point two.

Pakistan's July CPI eased to 9.2% from 11.1%, back in single digits for the first time in months, though prices still rose 1.2% on the month. Urban inflation ran 8.7% against 9.9% rural, while food remained the largest contributor at 10.6%. The SBP, meeting days before the print, held at 11.5% and repeated its expectation of reaching the 5% to 7% target band by June. The direction is right. The arithmetic is doing much of the driving.

Rupee, metronome.

USD/PKR closed near 278.20, once again inside a quarter-rupee weekly range through a corridor deal, a toll bill, a 5% move in crude and its own inflation print. The description settled on in these pages still applies: less an exchange rate than a personality. With CPI delivered and the rate decision behind it, Pakistan's macro calendar goes quiet until September, leaving the waterfront, and those pending deliveries, as the only moving part worth watching.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

EASING, OFFICIALLY

July CPI eased for a second consecutive month to 31.75%, the lowest since March and slightly below forecasts, even as monthly inflation accelerated to a three-month high of 1.78%. The Inflation Research Group's parallel estimate eased too, to 50.49%, measures cooled, and the roughly 19-point gap between them did not. The Finance Minister declared the rigidity in services inflation broken, while the central bank's next quarterly report lands August 13 and September 10 MPC is the next live date. Consensus sees no room for cuts this year.

Both numbers blink.

USD/TRY set fresh records near 47.71, the managed slide continuing at its familiar pace, with the effective overnight rate near 40% still carrying the policy load while the headline 37% waits for the inflation path to justify itself. The month being celebrated for disinflation was also the month the Lira quietly lost another half a percent. In Turkey, both things are always true at once.

Records, still.

Aliaga's vessel indications held at USD 262 to 284 per LDT across vessel types, stable but uncompetitive against the sub-continent, and unchanged in every respect that matters. Turkey's share continues to rest on EU regulation, Basel Convention compliance and specialist tonnage rather than price, while the Alang EU List proposal, the only development with any bearing on that franchise, remains pending. The niche was found exactly where it was left.

Niche, as found.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 32 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / Vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Steady**	445-450 / LDT	465-470 / LDT	475-480 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Steady**	443-448 / LDT	463-468 / LDT	473-478 / LDT
3	India	**Steady**	422-427 / LDT	442-447 / LDT	452-457 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	262-264 / LDT	272-274 / LDT	282-284 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- *72.55 million tonnes of CO_2 avoided through ship recycling at Alang is comparable to the emissions from burning roughly* ***31 billion litres of petrol.***

- *Ship recycling at Alang is estimated to have saved around* ***44.4 TWh of energy****, enough to power* ***more than two years of global container-port cargo handling****.*

- ***72.55 million tonnes of CO_2 avoided at Alang exceeds Portugal's annual greenhouse-gas emissions****, matching the scale of an entire industrialised country's yearly footprint.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
August 15 – Independence Day	August 09 – August 18 August 26 – September 03

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
August 26 - Eid-e-Milad-un-Nabi	August 12 – August 15 August 28 – August 31

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
August 14 – Independence Day August 25 – Eid Milad-un-Nabi	August 30 – Victory Day

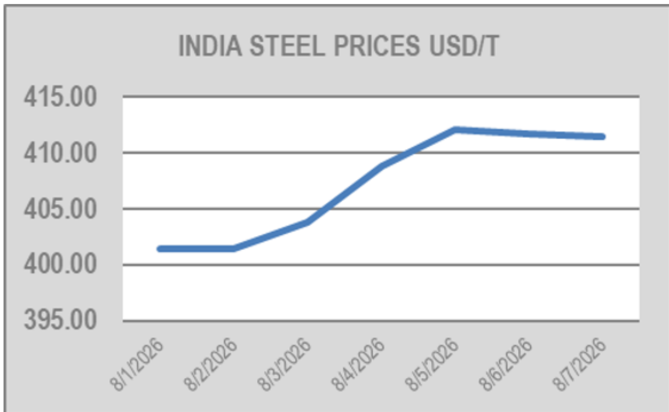
ALANG - Port Position as of August 07, 2026				
No.	**VESSEL NAME**	**LDT**	**TYPE**	**STATUS**
1	FT Island	43,402	Oil Tanker	Arrived July 31
2	Endeavour	835	Fishing	*Delivered July 31*

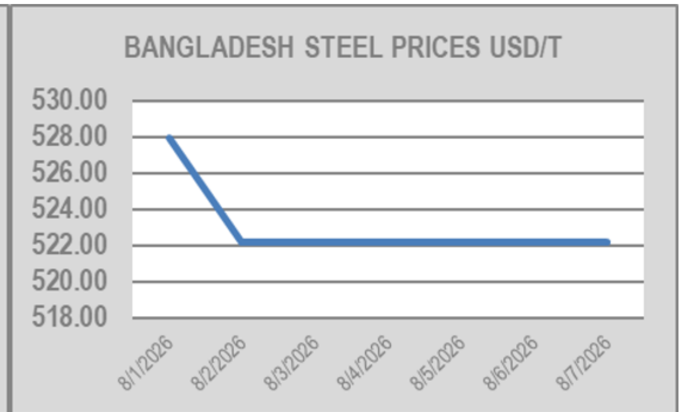
CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of August 07, 2026				
No.	**VESSEL NAME**	**LDT**	**TYPE**	**STATUS**
1	Avunda Reefer	4,085	Refrigerated Cargo Ship	*Delivered August 06*
2	Gas II	2,214	LPG Tanker	*Delivered August 04*
3	Su Shun	1,660	LPG Tanker	Arrived August 01

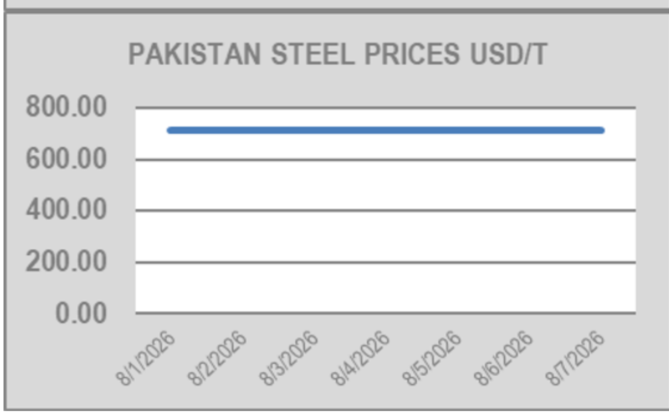
GADANI - Port Position as of August 07, 2026				
No.	**VESSEL NAME**	**LDT**	**TYPE**	**STATUS**
No new vessels reported.				

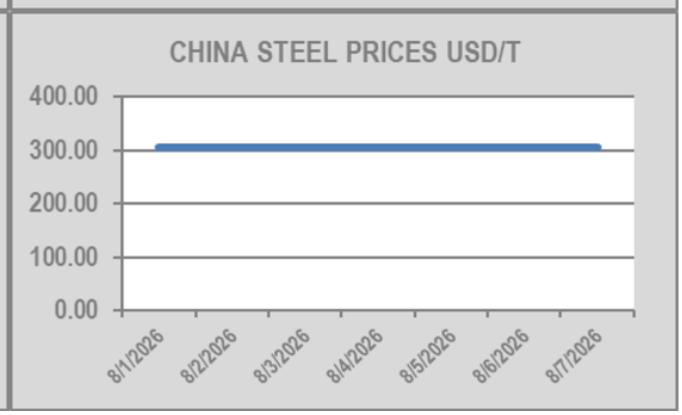
Steel Plate Prices

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
8/1/2026	401.51	38,300.00	714.29	200,000.00	527.95	64,700.00	306.32
8/2/2026	401.51	38,300.00	714.29	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	306.32
8/3/2026	403.82	38,500.00	714.29	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	306.32
8/4/2026	408.89	39,000.00	714.29	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	306.32
8/5/2026	412.07	39,200.00	714.29	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	306.32
8/6/2026	411.68	39,200.00	714.29	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	306.32
8/7/2026	411.46	39,200.00	714.29	200,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	306.32









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